Humayun and supervised the building of Humayun's tomb.

Gulbadan (1523–1603): Daughter of Babur and sister of Humayun. Accompanied Akbar to Hindustan and lived a long and adventurous life, performing a women-only hajj that lasted seven years. Greatly loved and admired by Akbar. Was asked by Akbar to write an account of her brother's life. This account was the first one by a Mughal woman and gave an unprecedented look into the Mughal harem.

Hamida Banu Begum (1527–1604): Persian wife of Humayun and mother of Akbar. Very influential, especially once Akbar became Padshah at the age of thirteen. Was given the title Maryam Makani.

Maham Anaga (d. 1562): Akbar's milk mother, Adham Khan's mother. Participated in the fall from power of Bairam Khan. Was considered effective 'ruler' of Hindustan between 1560 and her death in 1562.

Adham Khan (1531–1562): Milk brother of Akbar, son of Maham Anaga. Resented the curtailing of his powers by Akbar. Was killed on Akbar's orders for having murdered Shamsuddin Ataka Khan.

Salima Sultan Begum (1539–1612): Granddaughter of Babur and wife of Bairam Khan. Akbar married her after Bairam Khan was killed. Influential, erudite, and a keen collector of books. Greatly respected by her stepson Salim.

Mirza Muhammad Hakim (1553–1585): Son of Humayun and Mahchuchak Begum, half-brother of Akbar. Held the appanage of Kabul. Tried to declare himself the legitimate Timurid heir of Humayun in the 1580s, with the support of the rebellious Uzbeks. Positioned himself as an orthodox Sunni ruler as opposed to Akbar's eclectic religious views. Was defeated by Akbar in 1582 and died of alcoholism in 1585.

Shamsuddin Muhammad Ataka Khan Ghaznavi (d. 1562): Foster father of Akbar and husband of Jiji Anaga. Held the high post of khankhanan. Part of the large Ataka Khail. Became powerful after the fall of Bairam Khan. Was murdered by Adham Khan.

Jiji Anaga (d. 1600): Milk mother of Akbar, mother of Aziz Koka, wife of Shamsuddin Ataka. Her large and influential family were collectively known as the Ataka Khail.